RANDOMIZED COMPUTATION, CONTINUED

RC RECAP I

Last time

Probabilistic Turing machine (PTM)

Two transition functions δ_0, δ_1

At each step, pick transition δ_i, $i \in \{0,1\}$ with probability $1/2$

$L \in \boxed{BPP}$ if exists probabilistic Turing machine that

(1) Always runs in polynomial time for all x (regardless of random choices)

(2) $\boxed{\Pr_{\text{random choices}}\left[M(x) = L(x) \right] \geq 2/3}$ for all x

Can also think of this as standard deterministic Turing machine with pre-filled random tape

Important: If $L \in BPP$ as shown by PTM M, then for all x either

a) $2/3 \leq \Pr[M(x)=1] \leq 1$ if $x \in L$

b) $0 \leq \Pr[M(x)=1] \leq 1/3$ if $x \notin L$

Never $1/3 < \Pr[M(x)=1] < 2/3$

Widely believed that $\boxed{P = BPP}$

But there are problems for which we have polynomial-time algorithms with randomness but not without (as of yet)

POLYNOMIAL IDENTITY TESTING (PIT)

RC RECAP II

Input polynomial represented as algebraic circuit

Output Is the polynomial identically zero?

DEMILLO-LIPTON-SCHWARZ-ZIPPEL LEMMA

$p(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ non-zero multivariate polynomial of degree $\leq d$

$S \subseteq \mathbb{Z}$ finite set of integers

Then for uniformly chosen $(a_1, \dots, a_n) \in S^n$ it holds that

$$\boxed{\Pr_{\vec{a} \sim S^n}\left[\, p(a_1, \dots, a_n) \neq 0 \,\right] \geq 1 - \frac{d}{|S|}}$$

RANDOMIZED PIT ALGORITHM

Let m = size of input circuit C

Let $S = \{1, 2, \dots, 10 \cdot 2^m\}$

Sample uniformly $(a_1, \dots, a_n) \in_R S^n$

Evaluate $C(a_1, \dots, a_n) = val$

If $val \neq 0$ answer "polynomial not zero"

else answer "polynomial identically zero"

By DLSZ lemma, answer when $val = 0$ correct with 90% probability

Answer when $val \neq 0$ is correct with 100% probability

DONE ☑ Except: Can circuit evaluation be carried out in polynomial time?

NOT NECESSARILY ...

Problem If degree $\approx 2^m$, then intermediate numbers can grow as large as $(10 \cdot 2^m)^{2^m} \Rightarrow$ exponentially many bits

Cannot compute with such numbers in polynomial time...

Solution "FINGERPRINTING"

Compute modulo some $k \in [2^{2m}]$

After each operation, divide by k and take remainder

Suppose polynomial computed by circuit $C(x_1, \ldots, x_n)$

Suppose $A = C(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$

If $A = 0$, then clearly $A \equiv 0 \pmod{k}$

CLAIM 5 If $A \neq 0$, then for a randomly chosen $k \in [2^{2m}]$ it holds that $k \nmid A$ with probability $\boxed{\text{at least } \frac{1}{8m}}$

Given this claim run test $K \cdot 8m$ times for suitably large constant K with different moduli k

Suppose $A \neq 0$. Then test fails only if $k \mid A$

$$\Pr[k \mid A : A \neq 0] \leq 1 - \frac{1}{8m}$$

$$1 - x \leq e^{-x}$$

$\Pr[\text{all } K \cdot 8m \text{ tests fail}] \leq$

$$\left(1 - \frac{1}{8m}\right)^{K \cdot 8m} \leq$$

$$\left(e^{-\frac{1}{8m}}\right)^{K \cdot 8m} = e^{-K}$$

$\Pr[\text{randomized PIT fails}] \leq$

$\Pr[A = 0] + \Pr[A \equiv 0 \bmod k_i \text{ for all } k_i]$

$$\leq \frac{1}{10} + e^{-K} \leq \frac{1}{3}$$

for K chosen large enough. $\boxtimes$

<u>Proof of Claim 5</u>

Assume $A \neq 0$ We know $A \leq (10 \cdot 2^m)^{2^m}$

Let B = prime factors of A

Sufficient to show that with probability $\geq \delta = \frac{1}{8m}$ k is a prime not in B

A has at most $\log A \leq 2^m \log(10 \cdot 2^m) \leq$
$\leq 5m \cdot 2^m$ prime factors

By $\boxed{\text{Prime Number Theorem}}$

$$\#\text{primes} \leq N \sim N / \ln N$$

Correct constant is actually 1, ~~but~~ see Thm A.23 in Arora-Barak for simpler version that is also sufficient

$$\#\text{primes} \le 2^{2m} \sim \frac{2^{2m}}{2m} > \frac{2^{2m}}{4m}$$

for large enough m

$$5m \cdot 2^m = o\left(\frac{2^{2m}}{2m}\right) < \frac{2^{2m}}{8m}$$

for large enough m.

So $\Pr[\,k \text{ prime not in } B\,] \ge \dfrac{2^{2m}/8m}{2^{2m}}$

$$= \frac{1}{8m} \qquad \blacksquare$$

Many natural randomized algorithms have $\boxed{\text{ONE-SIDED ERROR}}$

Might make mistake when $x \in L$ but never when $x \notin L$, or other way round

(We just saw an algorithm that is always correct when $x \in L$, though not always when $x \notin L$)

DEF 6 $\boxed{\text{RTIME}(T(n))}$ contains every language L for which exists probabilistic TM M running in time $O(T(n))$ such that

$$x \in L \implies \Pr[\,M(x) = 1\,] \ge 2/3$$
$$x \notin L \implies \Pr[\,M(x) = 0\,] = 1$$

$$\boxed{RP} = \bigcup_{c \in \mathbb{N}^+} \text{RTIME}(n^c)$$

Never false positives Positive answers Right

OBS 7 $RP \subseteq NP$

Proof Every accepting computation is a certificate, since if $x \notin L$ we know for sure that $M(x) = 0$. So just specify sequence of random choices that make M accept and check that this indeed yields accepting path $\boxtimes$

We do NOT know if $BPP \subseteq NP$
(but suspect so, since we believe $P = BPP$)

$$\boxed{coRP = \{ L \mid \overline{L} \in RP \}}$$

"Never false negatives"

Our randomized algorithm for polynomial identity testing showed that $ZEROP \in coRP$

So far, we demanded that our probabilistic Turing machines should always terminate within given time bound

Given general probabilistic Turing machine M, can define random variable

$$\boxed{T_M(x)} = \text{running time of } M \text{ on } x$$

Could be integer or $+\infty$

We can then take the $\boxed{\text{EXPECTATION}}$

$$\mathcal{E}\left[T_M(x)\right] = \sum_{t=0}^{\infty} t \cdot \Pr\left[T_M(x) = t\right]$$

of $T_M(x)$, if this expectation is finite

<u>Note</u> that expectation can be finite even if M could run forever

Say that M has $\boxed{\text{EXPECTED RUNNING TIME}}$ $T(n)$ if for all $x \in \Sigma^*$

$$\mathcal{E}\left[T_M(x)\right] \leq T(|x|)$$

DEF 8 $\boxed{\mathcal{ZTIME}(T(n))}$ contains all languages L for which there exists a probabilistic Turing machine M that

(a) M runs in expected time $O(T(n))$

(b) $\Pr\left[M(x) = L(x) \mid M \text{ halts}\right] = 1$

$\boxed{\mathcal{ZPP}} = \bigcup_{c \in \mathbb{N}^+} \mathcal{ZTIME}(n^c)$

"<u>Zero-sided error</u>"

$\boxed{\mathcal{ZPP}}$ zero-error probabilistic polynomial time
"LAS VEGAS ALGORITHMS"

$\boxed{\mathcal{BPP}}$ "MONTE CARLO ALGORITHMS"

THM 9 $\boxed{\mathcal{ZPP} = \mathcal{RP} \cap co\mathcal{RP}}$

<u>Proof</u> Very useful exercise

We should also mention that it is immediately clear from the definitions that

$$\boxed{\begin{aligned} RP &\subseteq BPP \\ coRP &\subseteq BPP \end{aligned}}$$

ROBUSTNESS OF DEFINITION OF BPP

(a) Error probability: constant 2/3 is arbitrary
(b) Could use expected running time instead of worst-case
(c) Biased coins would be possible
(d) Could even use imperfect random sources (so-called "weak random sources")

We will show (a) — see Section 7.4 in Arora-Barak for the rest

THM 10 For any function $f: \mathbb{N} \to [0,1]$, let $\boxed{BPP_{f(n)}}$ denote the class of languages L for which there exists a polynomial-time probabilistic Turing machine M such that for all $x \in \Sigma^*$ it holds that

$$\boxed{\Pr[M(x) = L(x)] \geq f(n)}$$

Then for all $c, d \in \mathbb{R}^+$ it holds that

$$\boxed{BPP_{\frac{1}{2}+n^{-c}} = BPP = BPP_{1-2^{-n^d}}}$$

This is referred to as $\boxed{\text{ERROR REDUCTION}}$ for BPP

Proof

We just need to show that

$$\boxed{BPP_{1-2^{-n^d}} \subseteq BPP_{\frac{1}{2}+n^{-c}}}$$

That is, given probabilistic Turing machine M with success probability $\geq \frac{1}{2} + |x|^{-c}$

for any input x, build PTM M' with success probability $\geq 1 - 2^{-|x|^d}$

M' will simply run M $k = 8|x|^{2c+d}$ times collect the answers, and go with the majority vote

How confident can we be that this is correct? Use material from Appendices A.2.1 and A.2.4 in Arora–Barak

Let

$$x_i = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i\text{th run of } M \text{ yields correct answer} \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\Pr[x_i = 1] = p \quad \text{for} \quad p \geq \frac{1}{2} + |x|^{-c}$$

In what follows, suppose $p = \frac{1}{2} + |x|^{-c}$ for simplicity in our calculations

$$E[x_i] = p$$

By linearity of expectation

$$E\left[\sum_{i=1}^{k} x_i\right] = kp$$

$$kp = \underbrace{\frac{8|x|^{2c+d}}{2}}_{\text{half of runs}} + \underbrace{8|x|^{c+d}}_{\text{expected extra margin}}$$

> If you repeat independent trials sufficiently many times, then you will get very close to the expected value with very high probability

<u>Example</u> Fair coinflips

# coin flips	outcome
10	less than 4 heads or more than 6 would not be outrageous
100	Expect between 40 & 60 heads
1000	Will definitely see between 400 and 600 heads
10 000	Bet your house on between 4000 and 6000 heads

More formally:

deviation from expected value

LEMMA 11 (CHERNOFF BOUND)

For any constant $\delta > 0$, and for independent random variables $x_i \in \{0,1\}$ with $\Pr[X_i = 1] = p$

$$\Pr\left[\left|\sum_{i=1}^{k} x_i - pk\right| > \delta pk\right] < \exp\left(-\frac{\delta^2}{4} pk\right)$$

Plug in $p = \frac{1}{2} + |x|^{-c}$

$$\delta = \frac{|x|^{-c}}{2}$$

The majority vote will be correct unless

$$\sum_{i=1}^{k} x_i < pk - \delta pk$$

The probability of this happening is bounded by

$$\exp\left(-\frac{1}{4|x|^{2c}} \cdot \frac{8|x|^{2c+d}}{2}\right) =$$

$$\exp\left(-|x|^{d}\right) < 2^{-|x|^{d}} \qquad \boxtimes$$

How is BPP related to other complexity classes we have seen?

THM 12 $\boxed{BPP \subseteq P/poly}$

THM 13 $\boxed{BPP \subseteq \Sigma_2^P \cap \Pi_2^P}$ $(\subseteq PH)$

Both proofs use error reduction as in Thm 10 plus some other ideas.

Proof of Thm 13 is <u>extremely</u> neat, but we don't have time...

Try to sketch proof of Thm 12

Proof sketch for Thm 12

Suppose $\Sigma = \{0,1\}$ for simplicity

If $L \in BPP$, then by Thm 10 (and Prop 3) in last lecture there exists a probabilistic Turing machine M that on input size n

- uses m random bits
- runs in polynomial time
- gets the answer right except with probability $2^{-(n+1)}$

which can be converted to a deterministic TM M' with a random tape of m bits and the same guarantees

For a string of bits $r \in \{0,1\}^m$, say that r is BAD for input x if

$$M'(x,r) \neq L(x)$$

For every x, M' succeeds with probability $\geq 1 - 2^{-(n+1)}$

$\Rightarrow$ out of 2^m random strings, $\leq \frac{2^m}{2^{n+1}}$ strings are bad for x

Count the total # bad strings

$$|\{r \mid r \text{ bad for some } x\}| \leq \sum_{x \in \{0,1\}^n} |\{r \mid r \text{ bad for } x\}|$$

$$\leq 2^n \cdot \frac{2^m}{2^{n+1}} = \frac{2^m}{2}$$

But this means that there is at least one random string $r^* \in \{0,1\}^m$ (in fact, at least half of the strings) that are good for all inputs x of length n $\boxed{\equiv}$

Run M' with string r^* hardwired as advice for inputs of length n.

Since all Turing machines involved have polynomial running time, we have
$m = poly(n)$ $\boxed{\equiv}$

What about $\boxed{\text{complete problems}}$ for BPP?

A typical complete problem looks like:

"There exists a Turing machine of correct type running within resource bound such-and-such"

"Correct type" deterministic TM – simple syntactic criterion

nondeterministic TM – ditto

BPP-type: For every x, M accepts x with probability $p \geq 2/3$ or $p \leq 1/3$ but never $1/3 < p < 2/3$

<u>Undecidable</u> to check this condition

What about $\boxed{\text{hierarchy theorems}}$?
Fail for similar reasons.

A final useful notion: $\boxed{\text{RANDOMIZED REDUCTIONS}}$

DEF 14 A language B reduces to another language C under $\boxed{\text{RANDOMIZED REDUCTIONS}}$, denoted $\boxed{B \leq_r C}$, if there exists a polynomial-time probabilistic Turing machine M such that for all $x \in \Sigma^*$

$$\boxed{\Pr\left[\, C(M(x)) = B(x) \right] \geq \frac{2}{3}}$$

Not necessarily a transitive relation.

$\boxed{\text{But if } C \in BPP \text{ and } B \leq_r C, \text{ then } B \in BPP}$

We could have defined NP in terms of randomized reductions instead, if we would have considered BPP a better formalization of "efficient computation"

$$NP = \{ \alpha \mid \alpha \leq_p 3\text{-SAT} \}$$

DEF 15 $\boxed{BP \cdot NP = \{ \alpha \mid \alpha \leq_r 3\text{-SAT} \}}$